do ‘as it would have amounted to spiking the guns of the Central Board.’[16] In all this, Purshotamdas played a notable role. He had approached Deshmukh and received an assurance from him that he would not accept any other post which the government might offer him as a sop. By the time the Board met on April 5, the members were unanimous in their support of Deshmukh. Purshotamdas also seems to have used his influence with Lord Linlithgow, the Viceroy, to press for Deshmukh’s candidature as Governor. In a letter to Nehru (when Deshmukh resigned as Finance Minister in 1956) asking him to retain Deshmukh’s services, Purshotamdas wrote: ‘I was responsible for insisting on Lord Linlithgow that Deshmukh be retained and made Governor of the Reserve Bank in spite of opposition from the Services and the British commercial community and I will frankly tell you that I have had no reason whatsoever to regret my decision.’[17]

At the meeting on April 5, Purshotamdas moved a resolution (seconded by C.R. Srinivasan and supported by B.M. Birla and Sir Shri Ram) that Deshmukh be appointed Governor on a salary of ₹7,500 per month. An amendment moved by Sir Homi Mehta which envisaged Sir William Lamond becoming Governor for three years followed by Deshmukh was rejected by a majority of 7:3, with the original motion being carried by the same majority. The government kept the matter pending, but it appears was almost reconciled to Deshmukh becoming Governor. As a *quid pro quo*, they made the Board agree to have a Muslim and European as Deputy Governors. Deshmukh’s notification as Governor was conditional on the Deputy Governor in his place being a Muslim, in addition to a British Deputy Governor. ‘It was privately resolved that this should be not only a suitably qualified person, but also one without any tinge of communalism.’[18]

The Board acquiesced not wanting as C.R. Srinivasan observed, ‘to put our strength to the test again so soon on a matter of secondary importance.’[19] In the event, Wajahat Hussain, an ICS officer whose name was suggested by Deshmukh, and C.R. Trevor were named by the Central Board for the post of Deputy Governors at their Board meeting on July 20. Wajahat had been a friend of Deshmukh’s from his Cambridge days and had served in UP and Jammu and Kashmir where he had held the office of Registrar, Cooperative Societies, Commissioner, and Revenue Minister (in J&K). Deshmukh was pleased that his suggestion was accepted but